Providers

Selection precedence (every call)

`per-request Provider field → runtime selection (POST /api/ai/selection) → configuration`

Chat providers

Name	Backend	Key?	Use when
`Echo`	None (in-process)	Never	Dev, tests, offline fallback
`KnowledgeBase`	`AiSuite:KnowledgeBase` entries	Never	Instant on-brand FAQ answers, zero cost; front layer before real AI
`OpenAiCompatible`	Any `/chat/completions` HTTP endpoint	Via `ApiKeyConfigKey` (or `RequireApiKey: false`)	OpenAI, Azure OpenAI (`…/openai/v1`), Ollama, LM Studio, vLLM

Translation providers

Name	Backend	Key?	Use when
`Echo`	None (tags `[lang]`)	Never	Dev, tests, pipeline verification
`AzureTranslator`	Azure AI Translator REST (3.0)	Subscription key via pointer	Production quality + detection
`LibreTranslate`	Self-hosted LibreTranslate	Usually none	Data-sovereignty / offline

Only configured providers register: empty endpoint/region = adapter stays out of the factory, and selecting it returns 503 `PROVIDER_NOT_CONFIGURED` (never a crash).

Adding a provider (no core changes)

1. Implement the seam (~30 lines): `IChatProvider` (`ProviderName` + `StreamChatAsync`; `ChatAsync` folds free) or `ITranslationProvider` (3 methods). Wrap HTTP with `ProviderResilience.SendAsync` for free timeout/retry. For Semantic Kernel: inject your `Kernel`, call `IChatCompletionService` inside `StreamChatAsync`.
2. Register in the consuming project: `services.AddSingleton<IChatProvider, MyProvider>();`
3. Select: `"AiSuite": { "ChatProvider": "MyProvider" }` (or POST `/selection`).
4. Add tests with a fake (never real keys).

Optional NuGet (consumer-side, never required by the base)

`Microsoft.Extensions.AI.Abstractions` + `Microsoft.Extensions.AI.OpenAI` (10.x, wrap any `IChatClient`); `Microsoft.SemanticKernel` (+Connectors.OpenAI) 1.80.1 (plugins/function-calling); `Azure.AI.Translation.Text` 2.0.0 (typed Translator SDK); `Google.Cloud.Translate.V3` 3.x; `Azure.Identity` 1.x (Managed Identity > keys); `Azure.Extensions.AspNetCore.Configuration.Secrets` (Key Vault); `Microsoft.AspNetCore.Mvc.Testing` (integration tests).